

English Grammar Reference: Nouns

Educational Series

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1 Definition

A **Noun** is a word used as the name of a person, place, thing, animal, quality, or concept. In a sentence, nouns typically function as subjects, objects, or complements.

2 Classification of Nouns

2.1 By Type

- **Proper Nouns:** Specific names of people or places. Always capitalized. (e.g., London, William, Mars).
- **Common Nouns:** General names for things. (e.g., city, boy, planet).
- **Collective Nouns:** Name of a group of persons or things taken as a whole. (e.g., Army, Jury, Flock, Committee).
- **Abstract Nouns:** Names of qualities, actions, or states that cannot be touched. (e.g., Honesty, Bravery, Childhood, Sleep).
- **Material Nouns:** Name of a substance or matter of which things are made. (e.g., Gold, Water, Wood).

2.2 By Countability

- **Countable Nouns:** Things we can count. They have both singular and plural forms. (e.g., Pen/Pens, Chair/Chairs).
- **Uncountable Nouns:** Things we cannot count. They usually do not have a plural form. (e.g., Milk, Furniture, Information, News).

3 Noun: Number

- **Regular Plurals:** Adding -s or -es (e.g., Cat → Cats).
- **Irregular Plurals:**
 - Vowel change: Man → Men, Tooth → Teeth.
 - Same form: Sheep → Sheep, Deer → Deer.
 - Ending in -f: Leaf → Leaves, Wife → Wives.

4 Noun: Gender

1. **Masculine:** Denotes a male (Boy, Lion).
2. **Feminine:** Denotes a female (Girl, Lioness).
3. **Common:** Denotes either sex (Student, Doctor, Teacher).
4. **Neuter:** Denotes a thing without life (Table, Tree, Book).

5 The Possessive Case

To show ownership or origin, we use the **Possessive Case** (marked by an apostrophe).

- **Singular:** The boy's book.
- **Plural ending in -s:** The boys' hostel.
- **Plural not ending in -s:** Men's wear.
- **Non-living things:** Usually use 'of' instead of apostrophe (e.g., The leg of the table, NOT the table's leg).

6 Common Errors to Avoid

- **Incorrect:** The sceneries of Kashmir are beautiful.
- **Correct:** The **scenery** of Kashmir **is** beautiful. (Scenery is uncountable).
- **Incorrect:** I have many works to do.
- **Correct:** I have **much work** to do. (Work is uncountable).